

大学英语四级考试

COLLEGE ENGLISH TEST

—Band Four—

(2023 年 6 月 共 3 套)

☆☆

敬告考生

一、在答题前,请认真完成以下内容:

- 1. 请检查试题册背面条形码粘贴条、答题卡的印刷质量,如有问题及时向监考员反映,确认无误后完成以下两点要求。
- 2. 请将试题册背面条形码粘贴条揭下后粘贴在答题卡 1 的条形码粘贴框内,并将姓名和准考证号填写在试题册背面相应位置。
- 3. 请在答题卡 1 和答题卡 2 指定位置用黑色签字笔填写准考证号、姓名和学校名称,并用 HB-2B 铅笔将对应准考证号的信息点涂黑。

二、在考试过程中,请注意以下内容:

- 1. 所有题目必须在答题卡上规定位置作答,在试题册上或答题卡上非规定位置的作答一律无效。
- 2. 请在规定时间内在答题卡指定位置依次完成作文、听力、阅读、翻译各部分考试,作答作文期间不得翻阅该试题册。听力录音播放完毕后,请立即停止作答,监考员将立即收回答题卡 1,得到监考员指令后方可继续作答。
- 3. 作文题内容印在试题册背面,作文题及其他主观题必须用黑色签字笔在答题卡指定区域内作答。
- 4. 选择题均为单选题,错选、不选或多选将不得分,作答时必须使用 HB-2B 铅笔在答题卡上相应位置填涂,修改时须用橡皮擦净。

三、以下情况按违规处理:

- 1. 未正确填写(涂)个人信息,错贴、不贴、毁损条形码粘贴条。
- 2. 未按规定翻阅试题册、提前阅读试题、提前或在收答题卡期间作答。
- 3. 未用所规定的笔作答、折叠或毁损答题卡导致无法评卷。
- 4. 考试期间在非听力考试时间佩戴耳机。

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2023 年 6 月大学英语四级考试真题(第 1 套)

Part I

Writing

(30 minutes)

Directions: Suppose your university is conducting a survey to collect students' opinions of online classes. You are to write a response to the survey about their advantages and disadvantages, and what improvements can be made. You will have 30 minutes for the task. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.



扫码听听力

Part II

Listening Comprehension

(25 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard.

1. A) She was involved in a conflict with bird lovers.
B) She was charged with mistreating animals.
C) She was on bad terms with her neighbors.
D) She was accused of violating a city law.
2. A) It will take time to solve the rat problem.
B) All wild animals should be well protected.
C) The woman was not to blame for the situation.
D) No one should go unpunished for violating law.

Questions 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

3. A) Communicate with astronauts in Mars Dune Alpha.
B) Work in an environment resembling Mars.
C) Build a Martian habitat in Houston.
D) Send in applications before Friday.
4. A) Ready-made food.
B) Food that is organic.
C) Food they grow.
D) Potatoes mostly.

Questions 5 to 7 are based on the news report you have just heard.

5. A) He apologized for scratching an athlete's gold medal.
B) He was asked to present a gold medal to Miu Goto.
C) He bit a softball player's Olympic gold medal.
D) He attracted public attention at a media event.
6. A) Have another picture taken with the Olympic medalist.
B) Apologize to the International Olympic Committee.
C) Get the damaged medal repaired.
D) Pay for the cost of a new medal.

7. A) Allow no one to touch them. C) Treat them as treasures.
B) See them as symbols of honor. D) Keep them in a safe place.

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 8 to 11 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

8. A) She covered its screen with a plastic sheet.
B) She connected it with her smart phone.
C) She decorated it with colorful stickers.
D) She bought some new software for it.
9. A) It may not be simply blue. C) It is more harmful to young people.
B) It includes unnatural light. D) It induces people to fall asleep.
10. A) He has had much trouble falling asleep.
B) He has had some sort of health problems.
C) He has stayed up playing computer games.
D) He has been burdened with excessive work.
11. A) Exposure to blue light is the chief cause of obesity.
B) Sleep may be more important than people assumed.
C) Sleep may also be negatively affected by natural light.
D) Overuse of electronic devices may cause heart disease.

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

12. A) What they wanted to be when grown up.
B) What their favorite cartoon character was.
C) What they learned from computer games.
D) What they liked to do most after school.
13. A) A stock broker. C) A mechanical engineer.
B) A pop singer. D) A basketball player.
14. A) Ambitious. C) Imaginative.
B) Sensible. D) Practical.
15. A) Relax their strict control of their kids. C) Impose their own dreams on their kids.
B) Help their kids understand themselves. D) Dismiss their high expectations of their kids.

Section C

Directions: *In this section, you will hear three passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 16 to 18 are based on the passage you have just heard.

16. A) Set up company branches. C) Introduce iPhones into its markets.
B) Improve its infrastructure. D) Promote Internet-ready phones.
17. A) They cater to Africans' needs. C) They are more powerful and capable.
B) They are more expensive models. D) They boast the longest battery life.

18. A) A large touchscreen. C) A voice-response device.
B) An old-school keypad. D) A digitally-designed system.

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the passage you have just heard.

19. A) It ensured sustainable economic growth.
B) It was strongly opposed by manufacturers.
C) It was cheaper than using fossil fuel plastic.
D) It satisfied consumer demands on the whole.
20. A) The capacity to mass produce it.
B) The U.S. federal government's regulations.
C) A boom in market demand for clear plastic bottles.
D) A rapid increase in U.S. petroleum chemical production.
21. A) Require companies to use 30% of new plastic.
B) Increase the supply of new plastic in the market.
C) Reduce the amount of plastic pollution in local areas.
D) Take measures to promote the use of recycled plastic.

Questions 22 to 25 are based on the passage you have just heard.

22. A) It studies dreams. C) It is a hotel for business people.
B) It rents a place for nap-takers. D) It is a nap research institute.
23. A) To find out creative people's work performance.
B) To see how many people can go without napping.
C) To understand the obvious importance of napping.
D) To feel how difficult it is to get his idea across.
24. A) They decline due to pointless meetings.
B) They depend on his ability to concentrate.
C) They enable him to enjoy a creative career.
D) They are affected by the overuse of social media.
25. A) Some bosses associate napping with laziness.
B) Many office workers nap during work hours.
C) Some bosses can concentrate without napping.
D) Many of his friends daydream in the office.

Part III Reading Comprehension (40 minutes)

Section A

Directions: *In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.*

You probably haven't taken the time to think of all the work that went into creating the shirt on your back. I mean, how hard it could be to create fabric and 26 it into a shirt shape. Don't machines do all that? Well, creating fabric from cotton, which is the most 27 clothing material, is actually a process that involves a lot of water, 2,700 liters per shirt to be 28. Take a look at the video below from *National Geographic* for some more mind-blowing 29 about cotton clothing production.

Clean water is 30 becoming one of the most sought-after resources in the world. Given how large the 31 and cotton industries are, they take up a lot of our fresh water demands across the world, according to *The Huffington Post*. The video from *National Geographic* was created to spread 32 of how environmentally harmful cotton is. But the situation can be made better. Through better water management and farming practices, water usage in cotton production can be cut down by 33 40 percent.

Called “Better Cotton”, this environmentally conscious product will save millions of liters of water a year simply from 34 the demands of cotton production. Cotton doesn’t have to go, since it is, after all, one of the most useful cash crops across the globe. However, as water supplies 35, farmers and consumers need to be more conscious of the effect that these products have on the environment as a whole.

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| A) abstracts | I) nearly |
| B) abundant | J) reckoning |
| C) awareness | K) reducing |
| D) conscience | L) sew |
| E) exact | M) shrink |
| F) increasingly | N) statistics |
| G) intense | O) textile |
| H) mend | |

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2**.*

The spoken web

- A) We’re growing more used to chatting to our computers, phones and smart speakers through voice assistants like Amazon’s Alexa, Apple’s Siri and Microsoft’s Cortana. Blind and partially sighted people have been using text-to-speech converters for decades.
- B) Out of these assistants, Siri is the most well-known. The assistant uses voice inquiries and a natural-language user *interface* (界面) to answer questions. The software adapts to users’ individual language usages, searches, and preferences, with continuing use.
- C) Some think voice could soon take over from typing and clicking as the main way to interact online. But what are the challenges of moving to “the spoken web”?
- D) What use is written online content if you can’t read? That is the situation facing *illiterate* (不识字的) African farmers. They are often denied crucial information the web offers many others. With a literacy rate in some parts of Africa at only 22.6%, farmers are often “underpaid for their produce because they might be unaware of the prevailing prices,” says Francis Dittoh, a researcher behind Mr Meteo, a speech-based weather information service.
- E) “The most frequently heard complaint is about rainfall predictions,” says Mr Dittoh, who lives in Tamale, northern Ghana. “They tell us the methods their forefathers used to predict the weather don’t seem to work as well these days.” This is down to climate change, he believes. Yet knowing when it’s going to rain is vital for farmers wanting to sow seeds, irrigate crops or take their animals out to the fields to feed on grass.

- F) Mr Dittoh says the idea of converting online weather reports into speech came from the farmers themselves, after a workshop in the village of Guabuligah. “They came up with this,” he says. Mr Meteo takes the online weather forecast, converts it to a short recording in the appropriate language and makes it available on a basic phone. Farmers ring up to receive the information. The local language Dagbani is spoken by 1.2 million people but is not served by any online translation applications. The service was designed to be cheap and easy to run, says Mr Dittoh. He plans to begin field tests this month, working with Tamale’s Savanna Agricultural Research Institute.
- G) The spoken web could also help the one-in-five adults in Europe and the U.S. with poor reading skills. But building the spoken web—web-to-voice and voice-to-web—isn’t straightforward. For software to understand pizza is served at Italian restaurants is easy. To cover multiple domains and to be able to have a conversation with users on every single topic is still a long way off.
- H) So although many computer assistants can answer simple questions about the weather and play music for us, anything resembling a wide-ranging human conversation is decades away. Artificial intelligence just isn’t smart enough yet. Even turning your voice into text—automatic speech recognition—is one of the hardest problems to solve, as there are as many ways to pronounce things as there are people on the planet.
- I) Siri has often been praised for its ability to interpret our casual language and deliver very specific and accurate results, sometimes even providing additional information. But it is still somewhat restricted, particularly when the language moves away from stiffer commands into more human interactions. In one example, the phrase “Send a text to Jason, Clint, Sam, and Lee saying we’re having dinner at Silver Cloud restaurant” was interpreted as sending a message to Jason only, containing the text “Clint Sam and Lee saying we’re having dinner at Silver Cloud restaurant”. It has also been noted that Siri lacks a proper editing function, as saying “Edit message to say: we’re at Silver Cloud restaurant and you should come find us” generates “Clint Sam and Lee saying we’re having dinner at Silver Cloud restaurant to say we’re at Silver Cloud restaurant and you should come find us”.
- J) Using voice interaction feels far more intimate than surfing the net the old-fashioned way. This is intentional as the informal tone of the assistant helps create an emotional attachment. But if something speaks, it must also listen. Our phones are always near us and they are collecting data about us all the time. This has already raised privacy concerns. The American Civil Liberties Union has stated that digital assistants create a threat to privacy from hackers. Some people have other concerns. They worry assistants will one day be used to deliver advertising directly to us.
- K) But digital voices need more personality to make them popular. Robots are not yet witty, Siri is boring. The benefits of using voice instead of tapping fingers obviously depend on the context. Doctors completing online forms about their patients by speech, for example, can dictate 150 words a minute, three times faster than typing on a keyboard. This enables them to spend less time on administration and more time with patients.
- L) Last year, speech recognition company Nuance helped a doctors’ surgery in Dukinfield, near Manchester, set up a speech system for the practice’s six doctors. Now they can dictate notes on a patient’s health condition and treatment and a smart assistant automatically enters the information into the right fields on a web form. Previously, the doctors made voice recordings that were then transcribed by secretaries—a process that was costly and likely to cause delays. The new system means letters to patients now have more detail.

- M) Using voice also makes sense when you're doing other things with your hands. Think about when you're cooking, and you just want to know what the next step in the recipe is. Your hands are covered with oil; you're not going to get on the iPad, so it's a lot more natural to talk. And speech obviously makes sense when you're driving. In the U.S., 29% of drivers admit they surf behind the wheel, according to insurance firm State Farm. This is up from 13% in 2009. No wonder using mobile phones while driving causes more crashes a year than drink driving, says the U.S. National Safety Council.
36. According to Francis Dittoh, their speech-based weather information service was meant to be inexpensive and easy to use.
37. Using voice instead of typing enables doctors to spend more time taking care of patients.
38. It is extremely difficult to convert voice into text because of different pronunciations.
39. African farmers unable to read often don't have access to important information conveyed online.
40. Some phone users worry advertisers will take advantage of voice assistants to send ads directly to them.
41. The spoken web is helpful when one's hands are occupied.
42. Some people believe online interaction would soon depend mainly on voice.
43. Setting up a spoken web is by no means an easy task.
44. Weather information is extremely important to farmers.
45. Some people are concerned about privacy because their phones are constantly collecting their personal information.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

The United States is facing a housing crisis: Affordable housing is inadequate, while luxury homes *abound* (充裕), and homelessness remains a persistent problem. Despite this, popular culture and the housing industry market happiness as living with both more space and more *amenities* (便利设施). Big houses are advertized as a reward for hard work and diligence, turning housing from a basic necessity into a luxury.

This is reflected in our homes. The average single-family home built in the United States before 1970 was less than 1,500 square feet in size. By 2016, the average size of a new, single-family home was 2,422 square feet. What's more, homes built in the 2000s were more likely than earlier models to have more of all types of spaces: bedrooms, bathrooms, living rooms, dining rooms, recreation rooms and garages.

There are consequences of living big. As middle-class houses have grown larger, two things have happened. First, large houses take time to maintain, so cleaners and other low-wage service workers are required to keep these houses in order. Second, once-public spaces, where people from diverse backgrounds used to come together, have increasingly become privatized, leading to a reduction in the number of public facilities available to all, and a reduced quality of life for many. Take swimming pools. While in 1950, only 2,500 U.S. families owned pools, by 1999 this number was 4 million. At the same time, public municipal pools were often closed, leaving low-income people nowhere to swim.

The trend for bigger housing thus poses ethical questions. Should Americans accept a system in which the middle and upper classes enjoy a luxurious lifestyle, using the low-wage labor of others? Are we willing to accept a system in which an increase in amenities purchased by the affluent means a reduction in amenities for the poor?

I believe neither is acceptable. We must change the way we think: living well does not need to mean having more private spaces; instead, it could mean having more public spaces. A better goal than building bigger houses for some is to create more publicly accessible spaces and amenities for all.

46. What are big houses promoted to be in the United States?
- A) A luxury for the homeless. C) An abundant source of comforts.
B) A reward for industriousness. D) An absolute necessity for happiness.
47. What is one of the consequences of living big?
- A) Many Americans' quality of life has become lower.
B) People from diverse backgrounds no longer socialize.
C) People no longer have access to public swimming pools.
D) Many Americans' private life has been negatively affected.
48. What questions arise from living big?
- A) Questions related to moral principles. C) Questions about what lifestyle to promote.
B) Questions having to do with labor cost. D) Questions concerning housing development.
49. What kind of social system does the author think is unacceptable?
- A) One in which the wealthy exploit the low-wage laborers building their houses.
B) One in which the rich purchase amenities at an increasingly unjustifiable price.
C) One in which the upper classes deprive the lower classes of affordable housing.
D) One in which the affluent enjoy a more comfortable life at the expense of the poor.
50. What does the author advocate for people to live well?
- A) Finding ways to turn private spaces into public ones.
B) Building more houses affordable to those less affluent.
C) More public spaces created for everyone to enjoy.
D) All amenities made accessible to the rich and the poor alike.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

Most of us in the entrepreneurial community are blessed—or cursed—with higher-than-average ambition. Ambitious people strongly desire accomplishments and are willing to take more risks and spend more effort to get them.

Overall, this is a positive quality, especially for people trying to build their own businesses. Apparently, if you're more naturally driven to set goals, you are more likely to succeed.

Actually, this isn't always the case. In fact, in some cases, extreme ambition may end up doing more harm than good.

One major side effect of excessive ambition is the tendency to focus too determinedly on one particular vision or end goal. This is problematic because it hinders your ability to adapt to new circumstances, which is vital if you want to be a successful entrepreneur. If a new competitor emerges to threaten your business, you may need to change direction, even if that means straying from your original vision. If you have too much ambition, you'll find this hard, if not impossible.

Few people are successful when they try to build their first brand. Unfortunately, for the most ambitious entrepreneurs, a failure is seen as disastrous, and impossible to recover from.

It's a clear departure from the intended plan toward the intended goal. For people with limited ambition, however, failure is viewed as something closer to reality. Remember, failure is inevitable, and every failure you survive is a learning experience.

Ambitious people tend to be more materialistically successful than their non-ambitious counterparts. However, they're only slightly happier than their less-ambitious counterparts, and tend to live significantly shorter lives. This implies that even though ambitious people are more likely to achieve conventional "success", such success means nothing for their health and happiness—and if you don't have health and happiness, what else could possibly matter?

Clearly, some amount of ambition is good for your motivation. Without any ambition, you wouldn't start your own business, set or achieve goals and get far in life. But an excess of ambition can also be dangerous, putting you at risk of burnout, stubbornness and even a shorter life.

51. What does the author think of most entrepreneurs?
- A) They are more willing to risk their own lives.
 - B) They are more ambitious than ordinary people.
 - C) They achieve greater nonconventional success.
 - D) They have more positive qualities than most of us.
52. What does the author imply by saying "this isn't always the case" (Line 1, Para. 3)?
- A) Ambitious people may not have a greater chance of success.
 - B) Ambitious people may not have more positive qualities.
 - C) Entrepreneurs' ambition does as much good as harm.
 - D) Entrepreneurs are more naturally driven to success.
53. What does the author say is of extreme importance for one to become a successful entrepreneur?
- A) Holding on to one's original vision.
 - B) Being able to adapt to new situations.
 - C) Focusing determinedly on one particular goal.
 - D) Avoiding radical change in one's career direction.
54. How do the most ambitious entrepreneurs regard failure in their endeavor?
- A) It will awaken them to reality.
 - B) It is a lesson they have to learn.
 - C) It means the end of their career.
 - D) It will result in a slow recovery.
55. What does the author advise us to do concerning ambition?
- A) Distinguish between conventional success and our life goal.
 - B) Follow the example of the most ambitious entrepreneurs.
 - C) Avoid taking unnecessary risks when starting a business.
 - D) Prioritize health and happiness over material success.

Part IV Translation (30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on **Answer Sheet 2**.

中国越来越重视终身教育,发展继续教育是构建终身教育体系的有效途径。高校作为人才培养的基地,拥有先进的教学理念和优越的教学资源,理应成为继续教育的办学主体。因此,近年来许多高校适应社会需求,加强与用人单位沟通,努力探索一条符合中国国情的继续教育发展新路,以使继续教育在国家发展战略中发挥更大的作用。

2023 年 6 月大学英语四级考试真题(第 2 套)

Part I

Writing

(30 minutes)

Directions: Suppose the student union of your university is organizing an online discussion on interpersonal relationships. You are to write an essay on ways to maintain a warm and friendly relationship with your classmates and on the benefits of such a relationship. You will have 30 minutes for the task. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.



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Part II

Listening Comprehension

(25 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard.

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--|
| 1. A) A man was bitten by a snake. | C) A man kept a 4-foot snake as a pet. |
| B) A man was taken to a hospital. | D) A man fell off his toilet seat. |
| 2. A) Where the snake had been taken. | C) How the snake was captured. |
| B) Whether the snake was infected. | D) Who owned the snake. |

Questions 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 3. A) Taking her trash out in fancy dresses. | C) Sharing her photos with famous movie stars. |
| B) Amusing herself by going to ball parties. | D) Posting her daughter's photos on social media. |
| 4. A) To make herself popular. | C) To please her daughter. |
| B) To amuse people. | D) To record her achievements. |

Questions 5 to 7 are based on the news report you have just heard.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 5. A) Eat as much as they want for \$10. | C) Have a meal even if they have no money. |
| B) Have a chance of winning a \$100 prize. | D) Get a free meal after answering some questions. |
| 6. A) It was brought up by two staffers. | C) It originated from a donation to her staff. |
| B) It helped to popularize her restaurant. | D) It was suggested by some of her customers. |
| 7. A) Fifty customers have offered donations. | |
| B) More people have been giving than taking. | |
| C) Many people have come to eat at the restaurant. | |
| D) Most staffers have received messages of kindness. | |

Section B

Directions: In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 8 to 11 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

8. A) He is a psychologist. C) He is a host for a TV program.
B) He is a famous writer. D) He is a primary school teacher.
9. A) Why social media accounts vanish without a trace.
B) Why parents raise their children in different ways.
C) Why people fail to respond to emails promptly.
D) Why friends break off contact all of a sudden.
10. A) They simply shut themselves down. C) They scream to get their parents back.
B) They avoid showing their emotions. D) They attempt to ignore the whole situation.
11. A) They may regard any differences as the end of a relationship.
B) They are on better terms with friends and romantic partners.
C) They try to express their feelings and thoughts effectively.
D) They attach more value to their relationships with others.

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

12. A) Their price. C) Their quality.
B) Their color. D) Their design.
13. A) Jeans are a typical American garment.
B) America makes the best-known brands of jeans.
C) America has the best weaving tools in the world.
D) Jeans are available in a greater variety in America.
14. A) They are artificial. C) They are unique.
B) They are natural. D) They are special.
15. A) They are for casual wearing. C) They are much too pricey.
B) They are popular with boys. D) They are worth the price.

Section C

Directions: *In this section, you will hear three passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 16 to 18 are based on the passage you have just heard.

16. A) He desires more in life.
B) He wants to see it again.
C) He feels as inspired as other audience members.
D) He longs to become a superstar himself.
17. A) It is rather unrealistic. C) It is somewhat complicated.
B) It is extremely artistic. D) It is relatively predictable.
18. A) They are biased against women. C) They are full of shootings.
B) They are basically misleading. D) They are too simple.

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the passage you have just heard.

19. A) It can highlight leadership. C) It is a means to inspire creative thinking.
B) It can help connect people. D) It is an intuitive way to solidify friendship.
20. A) Allow them to recite data points. C) Enable them to remember the main idea.
B) Make them more open to learning. D) Stimulate them to engage in discussions.

21. A) Inspire listeners' imagination. C) Convey fundamental values.
B) Enrich their own experience. D) Explain insightful ideas.

Questions 22 to 25 are based on the passage you have just heard.

22. A) Immigrants outnumber U.S.-born Americans.
B) Immigrants have been contributing to the U.S.
C) Another wave of immigrants is hitting the U.S.
D) The number of immigrants to the U.S. is declining.
23. A) More of them expect their children to succeed in business.
B) They have fewer chances to be hired by U.S. companies.
C) They have founded most Fortune 500 companies.
D) More of them are successful business people.
24. A) They have higher installment loan debt than native-born Americans.
B) Nineteen percent of them borrow money from friends and family.
C) Their level of debt is lower than that of native-born Americans.
D) Thirty-four percent of them use credit for their daily purchases.
25. A) Keep their traditional values and old habits.
B) Find employment in competitive businesses.
C) Borrow money from financial institutions.
D) Collaborate with native-born Americans.

Part III Reading Comprehension (40 minutes)

Section A

Directions: *In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.*

Morocco is responding to increasing energy demands by setting up one of the largest solar plants in the world.

The Noor solar power station is 26 in the city of Ouarzazate and, once completed, will generate 580 million watts of electricity. The World Bank estimates it will serve 1.1 million people. It's 27 to be completed soon.

Morocco's current energy comes 28 from imports. The nation hopes to get 50 percent of its energy from renewable sources by 2030. With demand for energy 29 at an annual rate of 7 percent, the new solar plant could be a 30 part of that goal.

"This makes Morocco a big 31 in the field of solar energy in the Arab region and the African continent. It could also be a forerunner for many other countries in the world that 32 on foreign imports of energy," said Ali Hajji, a solar energy specialist and engineering professor.

Experts believe that the Middle East and North Africa have huge 33 for solar energy projects. This is partly because of adequate sunlight and partly because technology has become more 34 in the region.

“The last few years have seen a realization of 35 how competitive solar technologies can be,” said Michael Taylor, a senior analyst at the International Renewable Energy Agency.

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| A) affordable | I) mostly |
| B) ancestor | J) operating |
| C) crucial | K) perhaps |
| D) depend | L) pioneer |
| E) initial | M) potential |
| F) insist | N) rising |
| G) just | O) scheduled |
| H) located | |

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2**.*

New Formula One Chief Hopes to Grab Americans' Attention

- A) For the past four decades, the leader of Formula One car racing, one of the biggest annual sporting series in the world, was Bernie Ecclestone, a former motorcycle parts dealer who built it into an international presence essentially on his own.
- B) A skilled backroom operator who speaks without a filter, Ecclestone said often that in his opinion, the sport was at its best when he was allowed to act as “a dictator.”
- C) Yet now the dictator is gone. After an American company, Liberty Media, acquired the Formula One competition recently, Chase Carey—a former executive with Fox Broadcasting Company and DirecTV who by his own admission is not a fierce racing fan—was named to replace Ecclestone and to try to renovate the organization’s management, reach and ambition.
- D) Among the goals, Carey said in an interview on Tuesday, is one that just about every global sport seems interested in chasing: increasing interest in the United States. “People have said we’re going to ‘Americanize’ it,” Carey said. “And we’re not going to do that totally. But realistically, there are some elements of Americanization that the sport could use.”
- E) While Formula One commands enormous audiences throughout much of the world, many American sports fans know it as that other motorsport, the one that is not *Nascar* (纳斯卡车赛). Formula One teams race far more technologically advanced vehicles around tracks all over the world—in magnificent events in places like Malaysia, Monaco, Singapore and the United Arab Emirates, and on tradition-rich tracks like Silverstone in England and Monza in Italy too.
- F) The series has an annual race in Austin, Texas. But within “a few years,” Carey said, he plans to bring another to a destination American city, like New York, Los Angeles, Miami or Las Vegas. Carey’s ambitious plan is two-fold: first, change the business model of Formula One, which he said was a “one-man show” under Ecclestone that had a largely narrow vision when it came to negotiating partnership deals; and second, alter the way fans experience the sport, both in person and remotely, so that connections between the audience and people within the series are easier to make.

- G) Increased digital access for fans, a more behind-the-scenes experience for broadcast viewers and innovation in areas like virtual reality—what is it like to speed around a track inside a Ferrari? —are among the possibilities. “The sport has clearly been underserved,” Carey said. “It doesn’t do anything digitally. There’s no marketing. It doesn’t tell any stories. The goal in this is to make the fans connect to the live experience as much as possible, and the tools you have to do that, we’re not using at all.”
- H) The larger question, though, is a familiar one: Is there room for Formula One in the ever-crowded sports landscape of the United States? Opinions vary, particularly because viewing habits among consumers continue to evolve. John Bloom, a professor at Shippensburg University who has studied American sports history, said the biggest challenge for any sport trying to increase its presence in the United States was framing itself in a way that had lasting appeal. “Sports generally become popular in some way because they establish a narrative,” Bloom said. “When I think of motorsports in the U.S., what we all think of is Nascar, and the narrative of Nascar is sort of rural, white, working-class Americans, mostly in the South, connecting with the atmosphere of those races. That’s the narrative. When I think of the narrative of Formula One, it’s a very different kind of audience.”
- I) That difference, Carey said, is significant. While some might immediately link Formula One to Nascar in terms of American growth, Carey said Formula One’s brand research had indicated there was very little crossover; rather, Formula One fans generally cite other so-called elite events, like Wimbledon or the Ryder Cup, as competitions they enjoy. “Other than they’re both cars, the Nascar fan base is a very different fan base,” Carey said. “It’s a very regional fan base. Formula One is a global, famous brand of stars. These are machines that shock and awe you.”
- J) Carey’s background is in deal making and innovation. At Fox Broadcasting Company, he was a top advisor for years, known for his skill in helping to lead the launch of the company into sports, as well as the start of Fox News Channel. After going to DirecTV, he positioned the satellite provider as a mainstream option in millions of households.
- K) Now, after Liberty Media paid \$4.4 billion to acquire Formula One, he is charged with making the investment pay off. “I think they can build Formula One in the U.S.,” said Patrick Crakes, an executive at InVivo Media Group who spent 25 years at Fox Broadcasting Company before leaving in 2016 as a senior manager at Fox Sports. “People don’t work on their cars anymore. They don’t want that connection anymore. It’s about technology and pushing the limits. It’s about speed, danger and risk. And Formula One has that more than any other racing series.”
- L) That is what hooked Carey, and he said he thought his experience was not unusual. He recalled attending Formula One’s Monaco race last year and being overwhelmed by the ceremony leading up to the event, the way the race charmed the city for days ahead of the start. In his mind, it felt like a *Super Bowl* (超级碗橄榄球赛).
- M) Then, on race day, he watched as the cars rocketed out of a tunnel and went screaming toward a tight turn with the city’s harbor and the Mediterranean Sea in the background framing the scene. He was fascinated. “You can’t help but be awed,” he said, “and I think that feeling can be translated to the viewer.”
- N) He added: “The broader sport is a little too inward-looking, and we need to be more open. In some ways, I’m glad to be coming from the outside. The guys who are in the sport forever are sitting there saying: ‘We can’t do that. We can’t do that because it’s never been done that way.’”

36. Chase Carey believes greater use should be made of digital technology to make Formula One more accessible to its fans.
37. Chase Carey was deeply impressed by the ceremony preceding last year's Monaco race.
38. One of Chase Carey's goals is to make Formula One more appealing to Americans.
39. A former motorbike parts dealer led Formula One for the past forty years.
40. Chase Carey thought the audience of Formula One could be made to share his feeling about the race.
41. Chase Carey used to serve as a top advisor for a major broadcasting company.
42. Chase Carey intends to make connections easier between the audience and the Formula One racers.
43. The new leader of Formula One admitted he was not super interested in car racing.
44. People's opinions differ as to whether Formula One can be promoted in the U.S.
45. Compared with other racing series, Formula One focuses more on speed and involves more danger.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

Supermarkets have long been suffering as one of the thinnest-margined businesses in existence and one of the least-looked-forward-to places to work or visit. For more than a decade, they have been under attack from e-commerce giants, blamed for making Americans fat, and accused of contributing to climate change.

Supermarkets can technically be defined as giants housing 15,000 to 60,000 different products. The revolutionary idea of a self-service grocery, where people could hunt and gather food from aisles rather than asking a clerk to fetch items from behind a counter, first came about in America. There is some debate about which was the very first, but over the years a consensus has built around King Kullen Supermarket, founded in New York in 1930.

For some 300 years, Americans had fed themselves from small stores and public markets. Shopping for food involved mud, noisy chickens, clouds of flies, nasty smells, bargaining, and getting short-changed. The supermarket imitated the Fordist factory, with its emphasis on efficiency and standardization, and reimagined it as a place to buy food. Supermarkets may not feel cutting-edge now, but they were a revolution in distribution at the time. They were such strange marvels that, on her first official state visit to the United States in 1957, Queen Elizabeth II insisted on an *impromptu* (即兴的) tour of a suburban-Maryland Giant Food.

The typical supermarket layout has barely changed over the past 90 years. Most stores open with flowers, fruit and vegetables at the front as a breath of freshness to arouse our appetite. Meanwhile, they keep the milk, eggs, and other daily basics all the way back so you'll travel through as much of the store as possible, and be tempted along the way.

In the early days, as the supermarket multiplied, so did our suspicion of it. We have long feared that this "revolution in distribution" uses corporate black magic on our appetite. The book *The*

Hidden Persuaders, published in 1957, warned that supermarkets were putting women in a “hypnotic trance (催眠恍惚状态),” causing them to wander aisles bumping into boxes and “picking things off shelves at random.”

46. What problem have supermarkets been facing?
- A) They are actually on the way to bankruptcy. C) They are forced to use e-commerce strategies.
B) They have been losing customers and profits. D) They have difficulty adapting to climate change.
47. What does the passage say about the idea of a self-service grocery?
- A) It was put forward by King Kullen. C) It has been under constant debate.
B) It originated in the United States. D) It proves revolutionary even today.
48. What did supermarkets do by adopting the Fordist factory approach?
- A) They modernized traditional groceries in many ways.
B) They introduced cutting-edge layout of their stores.
C) They improved the quality of the food they sold.
D) They revolutionized the distribution of goods.
49. What is the typical supermarket layout intended to do?
- A) Arouse customers' appetite to buy flowers, fruit and vegetables.
B) Provide customers easy access to items they want to buy.
C) Induce customers to make more unplanned purchases.
D) Enable customers to have a more enjoyable shopping experience.
50. What have people long feared about supermarkets?
- A) They use tricky strategies to promote their business.
B) They are going to replace the local groceries entirely.
C) They apply corporate black magic to the goods on display.
D) They take advantage of the weaknesses of women shoppers.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

The traditional school year, with three months of vacation every summer, was first implemented when America was an agricultural society and the summer months were needed for farm work. Since then, we've completely changed as a nation. Students no longer spend summers farming, but they aren't in school, either. The average American student receives 13 weeks off from school each calendar year—with about 11 of those during the summer. Few other countries have more than seven weeks off in a school calendar.

With the U.S. lagging behind other countries in academics, it's time to consider year-round schooling. One benefit of this change is that students will not fall victim to the “summer slide,” or the well-documented phenomenon where students forget some of the knowledge they have acquired when too much time is taken off from school. Decades of research shows that it can take from 8 to 13 weeks at the beginning of every school year for students to get back to where they were before the summer holiday.

But year-round schooling isn't just about academics. Teachers and students experience a closer relationship in year-round schools than they do in traditional schools and, in the absence of any long-term break, students do not feel detached from the school environment. These closer bonds and

greater attachment pay off. Research shows that students in year-round schools are more self-confident and feel more positive about their schooling experience.

But don't kids need time to relax? Some childhood development experts believe that time off from school is vital to healthy development as kids are not designed to spend so much of their time inside classrooms and the summer break provides a perfect opportunity to get outside. The problem with this argument is that most children aren't playing outside or even spending time with other kids. While some children visit summer camps, most stay at home, watching TV or playing games on electronic devices, which hardly benefits them.

The U.S. has changed from a farming economy to a knowledge- and innovation-based economy, so it makes sense for the school year to change as well.

51. Why did America's traditional school year have a three-month summer vacation?
- A) Students needed to help with farm work.
 - B) Students needed time to learn necessary farming skills.
 - C) The agricultural society then attached less importance to academics.
 - D) America lagged behind other countries in making a scientific school calendar.
52. What benefit will year-round schooling bring students in addition to improving their learning?
- A) It will help them get back to where their lessons started.
 - B) It will enable them to absorb what they have learned.
 - C) It will familiarize them with the school environment.
 - D) It will strengthen their relationship with teachers.
53. What do some childhood development experts believe about the long summer vacation?
- A) It meets students' need to study on their own.
 - B) It enables students to learn about the outside world.
 - C) It satisfies students' desire to stay longer at home.
 - D) It contributes to students' healthy growth.
54. What is the argument against the experts' idea of a long summer vacation?
- A) It does little good to most students.
 - C) It leads students to neglect their studies.
 - B) It benefits few students playing outside.
 - D) It makes students addicted to computer games.
55. What does the author think of the traditional school year in the U.S. today?
- A) Well-grounded.
 - C) Outdated.
 - B) Culture-bound.
 - D) Welcomed.

Part IV

Translation

(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on **Answer Sheet 2**.

改革开放 40 多年以来,中国对高等教育越来越重视,高等教育已经进入稳步发展阶段。高校学生总数已接近 4,700 万人,位居世界第一。随着我国经济的快速发展,人民生活水平不断提高,越来越多的人渴望接受高等教育。我国高校的数量和学科专业持续增加,招生人数逐年上升,教学质量也在不断改进,为更多年轻人创造了接受高等教育的机会。

2023 年 6 月大学英语四级考试真题(第 3 套)

Part I Writing (30 minutes)

Directions: Suppose the student union of your university is organizing an online discussion on college students doing community service. You are to write an essay on its benefits and the service you can provide to the community. You will have 30 minutes for the task. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

Part II Listening Comprehension (25 minutes)

(2023 年 6 月大学英语四级考试共考了 two 套听力, 本套真题听力与 2023 年 6 月第 1 套听力或第 2 套听力相同, 故此处不再重复呈现。)

Part III Reading Comprehension (40 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.

Whether you're just having a down day or a down period, taking a walk can instantly lift your mood, especially when you go outdoors. Not only can walking make you less depressed, but according to a new study, depression sufferers who took a 26 walk showed just as much improvement in their 27 as people taking medicine. In fact, 60-70 percent of the participants in the study could no longer even be 28 as depressed.

Bone density may not be one of the most exciting health benefits of walking, but it's an important one. People with stronger bones avoid *osteoporosis* (骨质疏松症) and all the problems that 29 with it, like breaks and other disabilities. And the best way to get strong, healthy bones is by doing weight-bearing exercises like running, dancing and walking, according to a large study. But as regards bones, it's 30 use it or lose it: To keep your bones strong you have to keep exercising. The researchers found that adults who walked regularly had better bone density throughout their lives than their 31 friends.

Taking a walk can be great for 32 your head or blowing off some steam. It also provides a great opportunity to 33 with friends and family, far away from electronics and other 34 at home. Even better, you set a powerful example because when they see you 35 the benefits of walking, they'll be encouraged to walk more, too.

A) accompany	D) distractions
B) approved	J) exclusively
C) bond	K) inactive
D) classified	L) occurrences
E) clearing	M) reaping
F) come	N) symptoms
G) daily	O) typical
H) definitely	

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2**.*

A Club Where Lions Dance and Traditions Take Root

- A) The first thing you notice in the staircase to the fourth-floor studio on Canal Street in Manhattan, New York, is the measured *thumping* (嘭嘭声) coming from behind a metal door. Just beyond the entrance, large lion masks were twisting and turning to the drum-beat. On a recent Friday evening, the teenagers made their way across the studio floor as they practiced Chinese lion dancing.
- B) “You want to play in a circle,” Victor Fong, aged 24, told his students at the New York Chinese Freemasons Athletic Club. “Take it slow and do it again.” The dance group, made up of 60 members, performs throughout the year but was now preparing for its biggest events, Chinese Lunar New Year celebrations, which will begin on Saturday and conclude on February 15. Teenagers comprise about half of the group, many of whom began lion dancing at the age of 14. About 100 current and past members of the dance group—which has been performing since 1956—will be among the 220 groups marching through Chinatown in Manhattan for the 18th Lunar New Year Parade on February 5.
- C) Mr. Fong has been involved in the organization since he was 15 and began teaching lion dancing three years ago. But the club also acts as a recreation center and safe *haven* (庇护所) for teenagers, with video games readily available. As many as 20 students show up after school. “The basic requirement for hanging out here is you have to learn how to lion dance,” Mr. Fong said. While that is not a formal requirement for being a member, everyone finds a way to participate in the Lunar New Year Parade, whether it’s by dancing, carrying a flag or beating a drum.
- D) Alvin Chau, aged 26, is an environmental consultant by day and a lion dancer on weekends. He has been a club member for 10 years and joined because of an interest in lion dance. “We’re a big family,” he said, shaking hands with other members as they walked through the door. “You know everyone.”
- E) It is believed that the lion dance began in the third century. Stories vary about how lion dancing came to be, but most of them include a monster named *Nian* who would terrorize a village. The villagers finally banded together and scared the beast away with *firecrackers* (爆竹) and drums. While lions are not native to China, some versions of the story include the villagers creating a monster of their own in the shape of a lion to fight off the beast.

- F) Today, the dancers travel across Chinatown going from business to business to bring good luck for the coming year. The new year—according to the Chinese lunar calendar—will begin on Saturday and marks the *Year of the Rooster* (鸡年), which is thought to be a symbol of positivity. “It’s almost like the dark night is ending and the sun is coming up,” said Ya Yung Teng, the digital collections coordinator for the Museum of Chinese in America. “It’s hopeful that we’re going to have a new day.” Roosters and chickens are not particularly strong creatures, Ms. Teng said, but they are numerous. “In a way,” she said, the rooster “stands for ‘We the People.’”
- G) The lion head and tail are operated by two people. As one person controls the head, a second follows under a train of fabric representing the body. The dancers move in harmony as they imitate the animal’s natural movements in the wild, including the aggressiveness of an attack. A lion head figure weighs under 10 pounds and sits squarely on the dancer’s shoulders. Inside, the dancer manipulates strings that open and close the lion’s eyes, shake its ears and open its mouth to reveal a fire-orange tongue.
- H) “A good lion dancer will imitate a living creature,” said Karlin Chan, aged 59, who heads the athletic club’s community public relations. “I started lion dancing when I was a kid,” he said. “Chinatown was much smaller then and it was a celebration with fireworks and firecrackers, which added a lot of flavor and meaning to it.”
- I) Mr. Chan buys a new lion head each year when he travels to China. A head costs about \$1,500. “If you want the good stuff, the quality, you have to see it for yourself,” he said. “I’ll inspect the product before we put it in the container and ship it over.” Mr. Chan, who has been involved with the club for nearly 50 years, said that passing the dance from one generation to the next was vital. “You need to pass on the traditions and the culture, and this is a part of our culture,” he said. “It’s a great way to promote cultural understanding and exchange; we welcome that.”
- J) For Sara Pore, aged 17, another club member, lion dance is more than just tradition; it provides a creative outlet. “Lion dancing started 2,000 years ago—that’s incredible,” she said. “But what makes you a competent lion dancer is that there’s a sense of imagination involved. Lion dancing teaches competence in leadership because of this. You’re constantly forced to push yourself past your limit.”
- K) Back at *rehearsal* (排练), Justin Le, aged 18, tied a red ribbon around his waist to practice jumping. The dancers use the ribbons to pull themselves up over their partners’ heads. The room’s ceilings are too low to wear the lion heads for jumping practice, so once up on his partner’s head, Mr. Le held out his arms as if in offering.
- L) Mr. Le comes by the dance as a *legacy* (传承). “I was born into it,” Mr. Le said, noting that his uncle and father were club members. “Growing up, I would always watch my family and see the lion dance, and I slowly grew interested in it.” By the age of 14, he was fully enrolled in the athletic club’s lion dance group. “I value my culture and tradition, being Chinese or Asian-American. I have a lot of pride in that,” he said. “I want to contribute and give back to the community.”
36. The lion dancers perform from door to door to bring New Year wishes to business people.
37. The New York dance club also serves as a place for entertainment where youngsters can enjoy themselves safely.
38. Lion dancers need to have a little imagination to perform well.
39. There are a number of different versions about the origin of the lion dance.

40. Some 50% of the members of a New York lion dance club are teenagers.
41. One club member says he feels proud of his cultural tradition.
42. Two dancers coordinate their movements, one manipulating the lion's head and the other its body.
43. One lion dancer compares their New York dance club to a family.
44. Lion dance should be handed down to future generations as part of Chinese culture.
45. One lion dancer learned how to perform from his elders.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

Team-building exercises have become popular for managers trying to increase organisational and team harmony and productivity. Unfortunately many employees resent compulsory bonding and often regard these exercises as a nuisance.

A paper published this week by University of Sydney researchers in *Social Networks* has reported participants' feelings about team-building *interventions* (干预), revealing ethical implications in forcing employees to take part.

"Many people see team-building activities as a waste of time, so we decided to look in more depth at what's behind this," said the paper's lead researcher, Dr Peter Matous.

"Teams are formed, combined and restructured. Staff are relocated and office spaces redesigned. All this is done with the aim of improving workplace efficiency, collaboration and cohesion. But does any of this work?" said Dr Matous.

The study found that team-building exercises which focused on the sharing of and intervening into personal attitudes and relationships between team members were considered too heavy-handed and intrusive, although the researchers say some degree of openness and vulnerability is often necessary to make deep, effective connections with colleagues.

"Some participants were against team-building exercises because they were implicitly compulsory. They didn't welcome management's interest in their lives beyond their direct work performance," said Matous. "Many people don't want to be forced into having fun or making friends, especially not on top of their busy jobs. They feel management is being too nosy or trying to control their lives too much."

In this study the researchers recommended a *self-disclosure* (表露) approach where participants were guided through a series of questions that allowed them to increasingly disclose personal information and values. The method is well-tested and has been shown to increase interpersonal closeness. However, to be successful it must be voluntary.

The researchers said there are numerous schools of thought that propose differing psychological methods for strengthening relationships. "With caution, many relational methods to improve teams and organisations can be borrowed from other fields. The question is how to apply them effectively to strengthen an entire collective, which is more than just the sum of individual relationships," said Dr Matous.

46. Why are many employees opposed to team-building exercises?
- A) They consider such exercises annoying.
 - B) They deem these exercises counter-productive.
 - C) They see such exercises as harmful to harmony.
 - D) They find these exercises too demanding.
47. What did Dr Matous and his team do to find out whether team-building activities would improve productivity?
- A) They relocated team leaders and their offices.
 - B) They rearranged the staff and office spaces.
 - C) They redesigned the staff's work schedules.
 - D) They reintroduced some cohesive activities.
48. What did the study by Matous' team find about some team-building exercises?
- A) They were intended to share personal attitudes and relationships.
 - B) They implicitly added to the vulnerability of team members.
 - C) They invariably strengthened connections among colleagues.
 - D) They were regarded as an intrusion into employees' private lives.
49. How can the self-disclosure approach succeed in increasing interpersonal closeness?
- A) By allowing participants freedom to express themselves.
 - B) By applying it to employees who volunteer to participate.
 - C) By arranging in proper order the questions participants face.
 - D) By guiding employees through a series of steps in team building.
50. What does Matous think of the various psychological methods borrowed from other fields for strengthening relationships?
- A) They must be used in combination for an entire collective.
 - B) They prioritise some psychological aspects over others.
 - C) They place too much stress on individual relationships.
 - D) They have to be applied cautiously to be effective.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

There are close to 58,000 homeless people in Los Angeles county. That's a shocking and tragic number for a region that's home to some of the richest people in the world. At last, the problem became so acute—and so visible—that Los Angeles took extraordinary action. The citizens of this county voted in November 2016 and again in March 2017 to raise their own taxes. The purpose of such action is to fund an enormous multibillion-dollar, 10-year program of housing and social services for the homeless.

As a result, Los Angeles now has its best chance in decades to combat homelessness. This is an opportunity that surely all can agree must not be wasted. It is neither desirable nor morally acceptable nor practical for this county to tolerate the signs of deprivation more commonly associated with the *slums* (贫民窟) of Rio de Janiero.

How did we get here? For as long as there are homeless people, there is a tendency to blame the victims themselves for their condition—to see their failure to thrive as an issue of character, of moral weakness, of laziness. But contrary to popular belief, the homeless in Los Angeles are not mostly mentally ill or drug addicted or frightening, although a sizable minority meet some of those descriptions. Today, a greater and greater proportion of people living on the streets are there

because of bad luck or a series of mistakes, or because the economy forgot them—they lost a job or were *evicted* (逐出) or fled an abusive marriage just as the housing market was growing increasingly unforgiving.

The challenges are enormous, even if everyone is pulling in the same direction. That reality was driven home this month by a new Los Angeles Homeless Services Authority report showing that the county's homeless population is growing faster than the supply of new housing.

In the world's richest nation, homelessness on this scale should be shameful and shocking. But most Los Angeles residents are no longer either shocked or shamed. Increasingly, we are uncomfortable, annoyed, disgusted, scared or unaware. *Compassion* (同情心) is being replaced by resignation.

51. Why did the citizens of Los Angeles vote to raise their own taxes?
- A) To combat the county's homelessness.
 - B) To reform the county's service system.
 - C) To fund the development of local infrastructure.
 - D) To narrow the gap between the rich and the poor.
52. What do people tend to believe about the homeless?
- A) They seldom meet the descriptions of homelessness.
 - B) They are the victims of fast economic development.
 - C) They are responsible for their own condition.
 - D) They account for the majority of drug addicts.
53. What is one of the causes for more and more people in Los Angeles to become homeless?
- A) They find it increasingly difficult to afford a place to live.
 - B) The divorce rate in the county has been on a steady rise.
 - C) They have been compelled to take low-paying jobs.
 - D) The society fails to forgive them for their mistakes.
54. What do we learn from the new Los Angeles Homeless Services Authority report?
- A) Supplying enough job opportunities for the homeless remains a challenge.
 - B) Everyone is pulling in the same direction to solve the homelessness problem.
 - C) The increase in new housing falls short of the demand of the growing homeless population.
 - D) Los Angeles' homeless condition is deteriorating faster than many people predict.
55. How do most Los Angeles residents now feel about homelessness?
- A) They are increasingly ashamed about its scale.
 - B) They find it no more scaring than it appears.
 - C) They are less and less indifferent to it.
 - D) They no longer find it shocking.

Part IV

Translation

(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on **Answer Sheet 2**.

中国政府一直大力推行义务教育 (compulsory education), 以使每个儿童都享有受教育的机会。自 1986 年《义务教育法》生效以来, 经过不懈努力, 实现了在全国推行义务教育的目标。如今, 在中国, 儿童年满六周岁开始上小学, 从小学到初中一共接受九年义务教育。从 2008 年秋季学期开始, 义务教育阶段学生无需缴纳学费。随着一系列教育改革举措的实施, 中国义务教育的质量也有显著提高。